

Chapter 35-1

Yin Lingzhu hurriedly ran to Ming Qingyun's¹ location.

Because Yan Si was wearing a dress, her movements were somewhat inconvenient.

She also didn't dare let Yin Lingzhu discover she was following, so she could only try her best to find cover.

The three of them came to the rehearsal room.

Yin Lingzhu also recognized the person Ming Qingyun had brought - it was an acting-focused actor² who had debuted several years ago.

Moreover, their age was about the same as hers, which made Yin Lingzhu feel somewhat at ease.

She wouldn't feel awkward with someone her own age. If it were someone much older or younger than her, she might feel uncomfortable.

When Yin Lingzhu arrived at the rehearsal room, it was around eight o'clock. By the time she came out of the room, it was already twelve o'clock.

For privacy reasons, the rehearsal room's windows were not placed facing the corridor, but on another wall instead.

Yan Si couldn't see what was happening inside, so she could only hide in the room next to the rehearsal location, pressing her ear against the wall to listen to the sounds from next door.

The occasional laughter and practice sounds from inside made Yan Si feel tormented.

Yan Si wanted to push the door open and enter several times, but she forcibly stopped herself each time.

It wasn't until she heard the door being opened again that Yan Si's constantly tense nerves finally relaxed.

After thanking them, Yin Lingzhu left the rehearsal room.

Just as Yan Si was preparing to open the door and leave as well, she heard that there were still people in the rehearsal room.

It was Ming Qingyun and the other person who hadn't left yet.

"Sigh, after working hard all evening, you're happy now, but I'm the one who suffered." Her friend sat down in a chair, teasing as she spoke.

Ming Qingyun's lips also curved into a smile, not particularly caring. "For me, sacrificing you is very worthwhile."

"Do you really like her that much?" her friend asked. "Is it really her or no one else?"

Ming Qingyun didn't speak, but her friend already understood.

"Fine, you're invincible in the business world, so it's about time you got a taste of defeat in love." Her friend seemed to be both sighing and gloating.

Ming Qingyun looked at her. "Are you certain?"

Her friend patted her shoulder. "Based on my experience of having boyfriends since middle school, your chances aren't great."

"Nonsense." Ming Qingyun's expression turned cold.

Her friend wasn't afraid of her at all.

"Don't believe me then." Her friend looked at her teasingly. "Want me to give you some strategic advice to help you win her over?"

"Hmph, didn't you just say my chances aren't great?" Ming Qingyun glanced at her sideways.

"Hey, I said your chances aren't great, but that doesn't mean you have no chance at all." Her friend raised her eyebrows and put an arm around Ming Qingyun's shoulders.

"With my help, I swear by all my dating experience that I'll definitely help you catch her."

Ming Qingyun looked at the hand on her shoulder. "Just you? Your experience? Even dogs would find it disgusting and wouldn't want it."

Listening to the conversation, as the topic became increasingly off-track, Yan Si finally left.

The next day's scenes - Yin Lingzhu kept thinking about last night's training while on set. This scene was finally performed successfully.

Yin Lingzhu sat next to the director, wrapped in a bathrobe, drying her wet hair.

She nervously watched the screen, afraid the director would say something was wrong somewhere and they'd have to reshoot.

"Good, Xiao Yin³ has improved very quickly." After watching, the director said to Yin Lingzhu with satisfaction.

Yan Si was also nearby, sitting silently on the other side of the director.

With a glance up, she could see Yin Lingzhu.

Hearing the director's words, Yin Lingzhu smiled happily - she wouldn't have to act opposite Yan Si anymore.

"Thank you, Director. I'll go back to eat now." Yin Lingzhu bounced up from her seat, her voice carrying joy.

"Go ahead, you've had quite a morning." The director said gently to Yin Lingzhu. "You still have scenes this afternoon, so rest well during lunch."

"Mm-hmm." Yin Lingzhu walked away from the set with cheerful steps.

The director watched her retreating figure, his face also wearing a smile. Youth is wonderful indeed.

When he turned back, he saw Yan Si emanating dark energy.

"What's wrong with you? Xiao Yin performed quite well. As her teacher, aren't you happy?" The director looked at Yan Si beside him, completely confused.

"No, I didn't teach her." Yan Si's gaze was fixed on the monitor.

On screen, when the scholar⁴ saw the princess, her face flushed red, her eyes seeming to be filled with light, making it impossible to look away.

But Yan Si knew that this kind of gaze was something Yin Lingzhu had acted out.

She wasn't truly falling for her.

Yan Si lowered her head.

The director looked at her appearance. "Sisi⁵, I shouldn't say too much about you young people's affairs."

"But I know that liking someone requires sincerity."

The director looked at Yan Si. "I know you invested in my drama for her sake, and even your willingness to act in my drama is because of her."

"But you need to understand that liking someone is a huge gamble - no one knows what the outcome will be."

"This scene was something you wanted added, but are you satisfied with the result?"

Yan Si shook her head.

"Everyone from the crew has dispersed. You should go back and think things through properly." The director said softly.

Yan Si also stood up and walked toward her hotel room.

Footnotes:

¹ Ming Qingyun: A character name. In Chinese entertainment industry contexts, this appears to be another actress/businesswoman who has romantic interest in Yin Lingzhu.

² Acting-focused actor: In Chinese entertainment industry terminology, this refers to actors who are known primarily for their acting skills rather than just their looks or popularity.

³ Xiao Yin: A familiar way of addressing Yin Lingzhu. "Xiao" (小) is a diminutive prefix commonly used before surnames or given names to show familiarity or affection.

⁴ Scholar: Referring to the character Yin Lingzhu is playing in the drama - a scholar who falls in love with a princess.

⁵ Sisi: A nickname for Yan Si. The doubling of the last character in a name is a common way to create affectionate nicknames in Chinese.